

Program Infector

A program infector virus infects other program files once an infected application is executed and the activated virus is loaded into memory.

RAM, Random Access Memory

Memory transient programs are loaded into RAM so they can be executed. It is the memory that must be used for revisable data storage, regardless of the location of the program manipulating the data.

RAT, Remote Access Trojan, Remote Access Trapdoor

Remote Administration Tool. There are legitimate remote administration tools included with many network management products, with helpdesk and other support software, and the like. These are installed with the system administrator's knowledge and consent.

Registry

The registry is a database used by the Windows32 operating system (Win9x/ME/NT/2000/XP) to store configuration settings.

Remnant

There are many approaches to disinfecting virus-infected objects. As a result, some people are surprised to learn that not all products remove all traces of a virus when disinfecting. Should this happen, the remaining virus code will not be 'active'—it will not be able to gain control in the flow of execution—so the disinfecting object is still 'safe'. These snippets of leftover code are sometimes referred to as remnants.

Resident Virus

A resident virus loads into memory and remains inactive until a trigger event. When the event occurs the virus activates, either infecting a file or disk, or causing other consequences. All boot viruses are resident viruses and so are the most common file viruses.

Retro-virus

Loosely based on the biological concept with the same name, com-